The Last Storytender: making the Prologue production ready

Status report and work order, written 2026-11-04 after a full test of the newest versions: the game on branch **all-merged** (commit 19be710) and Tilewright on **main** (commit fd4dc05, which includes the fix for the black "Game" window in exports). The game will ship with the Prologue only. This document lists what works, what is missing, what is broken, and what "production quality" still needs (cutscenes, progression at the lanterns, audio, polish), with where to change the code and how to check each item.

It supersedes docs/PROLOGUE_TODO.pdf (2026-11-04, earlier). That document's step 1 (beige void, ledge lines, collisions, overworld censor bars) has since been done by another agent and is verified here.

Verdict

The Prologue is not production ready yet. The three memories (forge, Pip, Maud) and their bosses play well from start to end, and the overworld looks and moves right. But a player cannot finish the Prologue: there is no rift, no Cutting Room fight, no publishing of the town, so the Margin Gate never opens. Every guarded chest stays sealed forever, Garrick's lesson can never complete, Save and Continue does not work, there are no cutscenes, no music or sound, and the lantern-post progression (stat upgrades) does not exist.

Area	State
Overworld look and movement	Good. Dark void instead of beige sand, clear ledge lines, solid gates/bars/stones/signs, stair art.
The three memories and their bosses	**Done.** Forge 11/11, Pip 12/12, Maud 12/12 automated checks, each played start to end.
Combat and enemies	Good for Bare, Mite, Dangler (12/12). Run-on, Censor, Ellipsis untested.
Restorations	Garrick, Pip, Maud restore correctly with rewards (story test).
End of the Prologue	**Missing**: rift, Scissor-Man, publishing the town, Margin Gate opening, an ending.
Puzzle sites and riddles	**Missing**: 11 guarded chests can never open.
Side rooms	Doors work; inside, nothing is interactive.
Progression	**Missing**: no stat upgrades at lanterns, rank does nothing, equipment does nothing.
Saving	**Broken**: no Continue after "Save and return to title".
Cutscenes, intro, music, sound	**Missing** entirely.

1. What was tested and the results

Test	Result
Tilewright unit tests	1,888 / 1,888 pass; type-check clean; full build works.
Exported game (Linux build, started normally)	Reaches the title screen with no errors (the black-window bug is fixed on main).
static_check (no browser)	26 / 26: no paper tiles, edges block, ledge lines everywhere, every gate/bar/stone/prop has a collider.
play_test	12 / 12: sign, crystal, Garrick, chest, pickup, post, dummy, lantern, looks.
combat_test	12 / 12: enemies, animations, Bare lunge, drops, rest respawn, proofreading.
forge_test / pip_test / maud_test	11 / 11, 12 / 12, 12 / 12: each memory and boss start to end.
mech_test	6 / 9: collisions all pass and the echo message shows; **the lantern-lifts-a-bar check failed twice** (passed earlier today on the same build; the keys-only run lifted another bar). Timing-sensitive; verify by hand (B-07).

Test	Result
story_test (new; real keys, memories marked done)	9 / 14. Pass: Garrick/Pip/Maud before and after, Quill given, binder click heals, F quick slot heals. Fail: lesson never ends, no rift, Margin Gate, Eraser Crumbs do nothing, save/Continue.
side_rooms_test (new)	Both doors take you in with E; 0 interactive objects inside either room.
real_play_test (keys only, no teleporting)	Sign, crystals, censor bar blocks then lifts with the lantern, post, plot hole, 18 fights won. Did not reach town: snagged on a small solid sign near (50,52) between trees.
shots_test	27 screenshots of every area, reviewed (section 7).

All tests are in tools/port/*.mjs. Run one at a time:

```
TILEWRIGHT=/home/user/calebwilsonit-tech/tilewrite xvfb-run -a node tools/port/<test>.mjs \
    /home/user/the_last_storytender/tilewright <out_dir>
```

2. Bugs and blockers (B) - must fix

B-01 [P0] Garrick's lesson never completes

Seen	story_test: four J strikes on the dummy each took 2 hp (999 -> 991), but lesson_step stayed 1; no hardcover_binding, no eraser_crumbs, no +20 M, no garrick_lesson_end.
Cause	tools/port/scripts/Storytender.script.ts ~line 93: for each "damaged" event it does game.find(`id:${e.entity}`). The combat plugin emits entity = the runtime id (packages/plugins/combat/src/combat.ts:131); the script lookup most likely expects the scene id, so it finds nothing and l.hits never rises.
Fix	Match the dummy another way: compare e.entity with the ids of game.findAll('tag:dummy'), or have the dummy count its own hits (script on the dummy) into a var lesson_hits.
Check	story_test lesson check passes: lesson_done 1, binding 1, crumbs 2, +20 M.

B-02 [P0] Save and Continue

Seen	Pause -> "Save and return to title" -> the title shows New Game but no Continue; the next press starts a new game (difficulty screen). Mnemosynth not restored.
Where	tools/port/screens.ts ~146-190: title.continue is visible only when {host.hasSave}; pause.title runs act('saveGame', {slot: 'auto'}); Continue runs act('loadGame', {slot: 'latest'}).
Fix	Find why hasSave stays false after saveGame (slot name "auto" vs "latest", or the editor play/preview not writing saves). Save everything in FLOW_SPEC 8. Autosave on resting at a post and on entering/leaving a memory. Test in an exported build too (saves go to the game's user folder).
Check	Save, quit to title, Continue: same scene, position, Mnemosynth, renown, items, flags.

B-03 [P0] Item effects that do nothing

Seen	Eraser Crumbs thrown at a Mite: hp 2 -> 2. Of 14 usable items only the healing ones work (Ink Vial, Warm Loaf, Ink Flask, Herbal Tea, Honey Biscuit, Clarity Tonic, Phoenix Draught).
Cause	items.json gives eraser_crumbs, sticky_note, ghost_pepper_ink, time_in_a_bottle, lantern_oil, memory_jar, reader_digest a "setVariable: used_<id>" that no script reads.
Fix	A script (Storytender or a new Items.script.ts) that watches those vars (or the item-used event) and applies: crumbs thrown 150 px, 5 dmg within 85; sticky note sleep 6 s within 240; ghost pepper 4 s / 280; time in a bottle 9 s / 360; lantern oil +100 light; memory jar +60 M; reader digest +12 R. Clear the var after.

B-04 [P1] Equipment (bindings, amulets, charms)

Seen	55 items have no use; the binder shows Binding and Amulet slots that cannot be filled; binder stats list is cut off on the left page.
Fix	Equip from the binder card (click on a binding -> slot), store equip_binding / equip_amulet, apply stats in Storytender.script.ts (speed, dash cooldown, damage, reach, armor, lantern burn, regen, Mnemosynth, luck). Stats from the Godot item_*.gd files. Fit the stats text inside the page.

B-05 [P1] Crumpling and respawn rules

Seen	Beaten by a Bare she wakes with full ink, but at the map start (16.5,54.5) even though she fell in town; no CRUMPLED narration; Normal difficulty Mnemosynth loss not ported; fall damage fixed at 15 (no difficulty).
Fix	FLOW_SPEC 2: respawn at last rested post, else nearest lit, else (87,53) in town, else start; Normal drops floor(M x 0.15 / 5) x 5 as crystals where she fell and gives 50 ink; Story 100 ink, no loss; dungeons use the dungeon's last post; reset enemies/echoes.

B-06 [P2] Snag points on the overworld

Seen	The keys-only run caught repeatedly on a small solid lore sign near (50,52) in a narrow gap between trees.

Fix	Shrink small sign colliders (0.5 x 0.5) or move signs out of one-cell corridors. Walk the whole overworld by hand once after V fixes.

B-07 [P2] Censor bar timing

Seen	mech_test "lantern lifts a bar" failed twice today, passed once on the same build; keys-only run lifted a different bar fine.
Do	Lift each of the 6 overworld bars by hand; if any needs much longer than ~1.4 s of beam, check Redactor.script.ts aim and progress (uses sim dt). Make the test measure sim time.

3. Missing Prologue content (C)

The original game (Godot, scripts/ in this repo) is the reference; tools/port/FLOW_SPEC.md has the rules in short.

C-01 [P0] The end of the Prologue: rift, Cutting Room, publishing, Margin Gate, ending

Now	scissor_rift_enter dialogue exists but nothing uses it; no flag scissor_done or restored_town is ever set; the Cutting Room scene has art only (meadow floor, Scissor-Man standing still); the Margin Gate always says it is shut.
Do	1) Rift prop at (88,53), shown when restored_garrick + restored_pip + restored_maud and not scissor_done, RIFT_NARRATION, "Step into the tear" -> scenes/scissor.scene.json (main.gd 431). 2) Scissor-Man (scripts/editor_scissor.gd, scissor_man.gd): clipboard (strike clippings, V pastes a patch lasting 18 s / 26 story), telegraphed cut lines, a cut through a patch jams him 5.5 s, only hurt while jammed, 90 HP, phases at 66% and 33%; win: scissor_finale, Thimble, scissor_done, +60 M, +40 R, back to (88,54). Editorial floor (docs/dungeon_plans/scissor_editorial_floor.png). 3) Publishing: PUBLISHED narration, town-wide restoration wave, restored_town + town_published. 4) Margin Gate: below 220 renown the renown text, else gate_open. 5) **An ending**: since the game ships with only the Prologue, opening the Margin Gate should play a closing cutscene and an end card ("End of the Prologue", credits, "thank you for playing"), then return to title with the save kept so the player can keep exploring.
Check	scissor_test.mjs and a test that goes rift -> win -> publish -> gate -> end card.

C-02 [P0] Puzzle sites: the 11 sealed chests

Now	Chest dialogues check site_<id> but nothing ever sets it. The 9 overworld echo plates have no script. 17 sentence stones and 8 story gates only block.
Do	puzzle_sites.gd / SITES data: echo sites (two plates pressed together open the WEIGHED gate), words sites (three sentence stones set to the right words, a sign gives the answer, bridge cells become floor), arena sites (PROOF gate closes, waves, opens), crumble causeways. Solving sets site_<id> and +4 R. Reuse forge.ts plates/gates and pip.ts sentence stones.

C-03 [P1] Riddles and vault trials

Do	r0 (stone 39,67, gate 37,65, chest 34,65) and r3 (stone 58,56, gate 60,54, chest 63,54): "Attempt the trial" -> word minigame (vault_trial.gd, trial_games.gd); win +(4 + 4 tier) R and opens the gate; lose "The words slip away. Try again whenever you like."

C-04 [P1] Side rooms: Weighing Room and Proof Room

Now	Doors work. Weighing Room: 9 echo plates, 8 gates, 4 weights, all inert. Proof Room: 4 censor bars, 3 sentence stones, a gate, all inert; its censor bar art is drawn giant and covers a portal.
Do	side_weighing.gd (rooms Tare, Relay, Night, Pan, Counterweights; the Locket gives echo_third, reward hourglass_of_drafts) and side_proof.gd (lantern-revealed plaques give ALIVE, UNWRITTEN, WELCOME; reward censors_monocle). Exits back to the overworld.

C-05 [P1] Rest of the overworld rules

Do	Region discovery (+10 M, +6 R, "Discovered" toast), ENEMY_INTRO narration for kinds 2-5, REDACTOR_HINT/OPEN, FALL_FIRST, enemy streaming and the 120 s respawn of a beaten Error, Run-on / Censor / Ellipsis behaviour after the restorations (test them), memory chests and posts (inside the memories they are decoration), dungeon pause items "Travel to a lantern" / "Restart this dungeon".

4. Progression: rank, levels and lantern upgrades (P)

What "Rank" is

In the original game there are two separate numbers. **Renown** is fame: you earn it by beating Errors, opening chests, solving riddles and sites, lighting posts and exploring. Every renown step (0, 40, 100, 180, 280, 400, 560, 760, 1000, 1300, 1650) raises your **Rank** by one and gives +10 max ink. Its main job in the Prologue is the Margin Gate, which needs 220 renown. Separately, **Mnemosynth** (the crystals) is spent at a lantern post on stats; each stat point raises your **Level**. The port shows "Rank 1 0 / 40" in the corner, but rank does nothing and levels do not exist, which is why it reads as confusing.

Recommendation (owner's request: upgrade stats when resting at a lantern)

- **One level, earned at the lanterns.** Resting at a post opens a "Revise Your Draft" screen where Mnemosynth buys stat points. The level shown in the HUD is that level.
- **Drop the word "Rank".** Show renown as what it is for: "Renown 35 / 220" with a small gate icon, filling toward the Margin Gate. (Optionally keep the +10 ink per renown step as a quiet bonus, or fold max ink into the Inkwell stat only.)
- Show Mnemosynth clearly in the HUD (it is the currency), with a readable plate behind the numbers.

P-01 [P0] Lantern post upgrade screen ("Revise Your Draft")

Stats	From scripts/game_state.gd ATTRS: Inkwell +2 max ink; Thick Paper -0.5% damage taken; Penmanship +1% Quill damage, +0.25% reach; Wit +0.025 ink regen/s, -0.5% lantern burn; Footwork +0.3% speed, -0.5% dash cooldown; Fortune +0.5% drop chance, +0.25% Mnemosynth found. Each up to 100.
Cost	Mnemosynth per point = int(20 + 4p + 0.08p^2), p = points spent so far (like a soul cost). 15 free points the first time (INDEX_FIRST narration explains it).
When	Opens after "Rest at the post" (checkpoint "rested" event). Resting also refills ink and lantern, resets Errors, saves the game. Also a "Travel" tab (fast travel to lit posts 40+ cells away), and in the original a Workbench (recipes) and the Narrator's Stall (shop, sell at 40%): include or cut them for the Prologue, the owner decides.
Where	New screen in tools/port/screens.ts (stat rows with + buttons, cost, Mnemosynth left, a preview of the change), vars attr_ink ... attr_luck, free_points; effects applied in Storytender.script.ts (max ink on the health component, speed, dash, damage, reach, armor, lantern drain, regen, drops). Saved with the game.
Check	Rest, spend 15 free points, then buy one with Mnemosynth: cost rises, stats change in play, survives save/Continue.

5. Cutscenes (none are ported yet) (K)

The original plays short cinematics: letterbox bars slide in, the camera glides to a person or place and zooms, dialogue or narration plays, the camera returns, bars slide out (scripts/level_base.gd cinematic(), hud.gd set_letterbox). Some dialogue lines carry cues (name_reveal, tear, restore) that trigger effects mid-conversation. In the port these are plain dialogue boxes with no camera work.

The engine already supports cutscenes: assets/cutscenes/<name>.cutscene.json with steps wait, waitInput, say, dialogue, cameraTo, cameraReset, move, face, fade, animation, shake, sound, music, setVariable, give, message (packages/runtime/src/story/cutscene.ts; run by the story plugin). A letterbox step may need to be added to the engine (or drawn as two black UI bars that a variable shows).

#	Cutscene	Godot source	What it shows
K-01	Intro storybook	intro_book.gd	New Game: 6 illustrated spreads (idea, tender, editors, doodle, you, blot), typewriter text 46 chars/s, Esc skips; sets book_seen.
K-02	Waking up	main.gd intro	INTRO_WAKE narration, the Storytender pops onto the page, tutorial cards "move" then "quill", two INTRO lines 5.6 s apart.

#	Cutscene	Godot source	What it shows
K-03	Garrick restored	main.gd 554	Camera to Garrick, zoom 1.45, garrick_restoration with cues name_reveal, tear, restore (colour wave).
K-04	Pip restored	main.gd 497	Camera to Pip, pip_restoration, restore wave; Run-on and Dangler appear.
K-05	Maud restored	main.gd 521	Camera to Maud, maud_restoration, restore wave; Censor and Ellipsis appear.
K-06	The rift opens	main.gd 431	Camera to the tear, RIFT_NARRATION, scissor_rift_enter.
K-07	Publishing the town	main.gd (PUBLISHED)	The whole town colours in from the rift outward; the end of the Prologue begins.
K-08	Margin Gate / ending	new	The gate opens, closing narration, end card and credits (C-01).
K-09..12	Forge: Critic intro, reckoning, finale, the First Sword	memory_forge.gd 252, 323, 347, 363	Camera to the Critic for each phase; to the anvil for the sword.
K-13..16	Pip: Spoiler intro, reckoning, finale, resolution	memory_pip.gd 435, 588, 687, 697	Camera to the Spoiler; to Pip at the end.
K-17..20	Maud: Empty Table intro, reckoning, finale, resolution	memory_maud.gd 238, 285, 415, 424	Camera to the table; to Maud at the end.
K-21..22	Scissor-Man intro and finale	editor_scissor.gd 208, 364	Camera to the Scissor-Man.

Each cutscene: freeze the player and enemies, letterbox in 0.6 s, camera glide (pan seconds and zoom from the Godot call), the dialogue, hold, camera back, letterbox out 0.8 s. Skippable with Esc after the first viewing. Music dips under dialogue.

6. Music and sound (A)

There are no audio files in the game at all (the Godot game also shipped silent, with slots ready). A production release needs both.

Kind	What is needed
Music slots (scripts/music.gd)	title, storybook, overworld (optional per-region), index (lantern menu), memory_forge, memory_pip, memory_maud, editor_scissor, boss_critic (+ reckoning), boss_spoiler, boss_cold_shoulder, boss_scissor, ending. Loop, crossfade, dip under dialogue and cutscenes, Settings > Music volume.
Sound effects	Footsteps (grass, stone, wood), quill swing / hit / finisher, dash, lantern on/off and burn, crystal pickup, chest open, item use, heal, hurt, crumple, fall, post light / rest, gate open, censor bar lift, echo record / play, sentence-stone rewrite, enemy alert / attack / proofread, each boss's attacks, UI move / select / back, toasts.
Engine	Tilewright has audio (runtime audio/engine, mixer; cutscene "sound" and "music" steps). Wire music per scene and a sound per event.

7. Look, UI and readability (V)

Done since the last report: the beige void is gone (dark background), back ledges have a clear dark line on every floor, gates/bars/stones/signs block, stairs use the new stair pictures.

V-01 [P1] Doubled words in Maud's memory

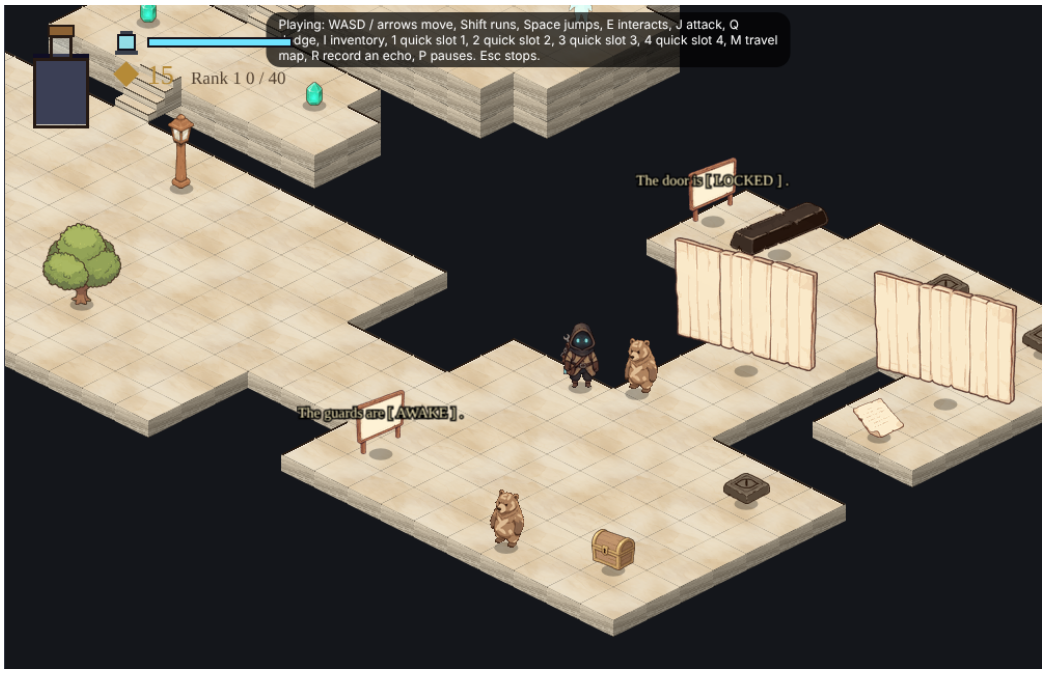
Do	Each word block shows a big outlined word and a small one (SERVE + SERVE, dough + DOUGH, BREAD + BREAD, SALT + SALT). Keep one: the Ludo word_* block art with the textBlock text hidden, or the text on a plain block.



Maud, the hall: doubled words on every block.

V-02 [P1] Pip's sentence stones are hard to read

Do	The sentences ("The door is [LOCKED].") are tiny outlined text over a small sign. Bigger plaque, dark text on light, word in a coloured box.



Pip, the archive: small sentence text.

V-03 [P1] Cutting Room look

Do	Floor is meadow grass (should be the editorial floor); the portal is drawn over the Storytender; the Scissor-Man has no animations.



Cutting Room: grass floor, portal over the player.

V-04 [P1] Proof Room censor bar drawn giant

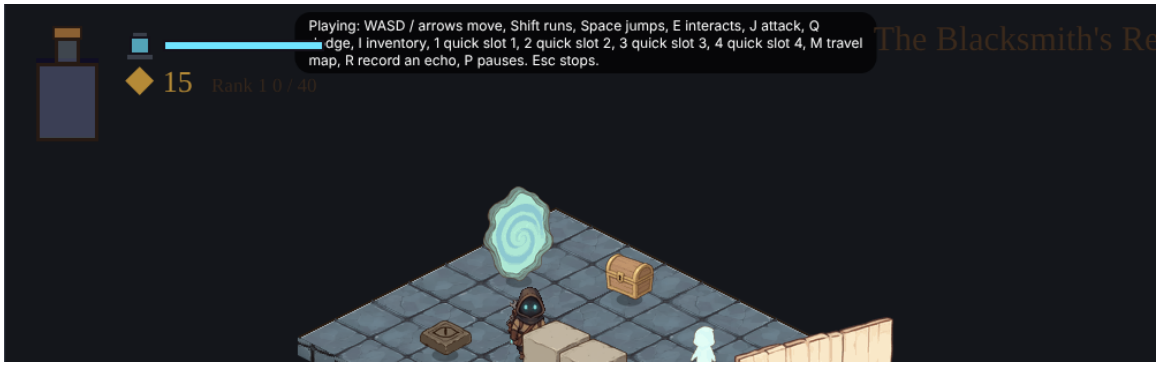
Do	Scale it to 3 cells x 0.7 like the forge bar; it now covers a portal.



Proof Room.

V-05 [P0] HUD

Do	Ink bottle draws as an empty dark box (show the ink level); "Rank 1 0 / 40" is dark text on dark (replace per section 4); the area name top-right is cut off ("The Blacksmith's Re..."); the "E: talk" hint is tiny and sits on the player. Add toasts (item got, discovered, rank/level up) and centre narration. Boss health bar with the boss name.



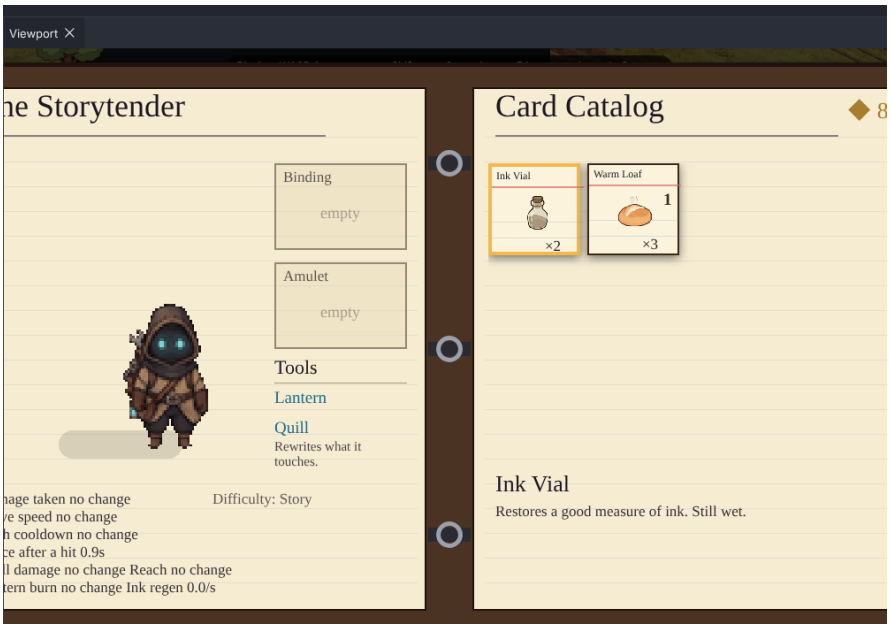
Forge start: empty ink bottle, unreadable rank, clipped area name.

V-06 [P1] Draw order

Do	Wide objects (gates, portals, bars, the big book in Pip's memory, sign posts) draw over the player when she is beside or behind them. Sort them by their footprint, not the picture bottom; word labels in the object's own layer.

V-07 [P2] Binder

Do	Stats text is cut off on the left page; Binding/Amulet slots empty and unusable (B-04); otherwise it looks good.



The binder: card catalog works; stats list clipped at the left edge.

V-08 [P1] Art still to make

Do	From art/incoming2/WIRING_REPORT.md: villagers in all directions, Scissor-Man animations, the rift, intro storybook spreads (6), end card art, editorial floor, word blocks, redaction bar, weighing tokens/weights/Locket/hourglass, item icons for Monocle, Thimble, Hourglass; also letterbox/toast/boss-bar UI pieces.

8. Production checklist (R)

Item	State / to do
Windows export	Fixed on Tilewright main (black window). Rebuild (npm run build) and export on the owner's Windows PC; play the exported build start to end.
Performance	The overworld ran at about half speed in the headless test machine (2.1 cells/s vs 4.2). Measure frame rate on the owner's PC; if low, cull off-screen objects and stream enemies (spawn 560-900 px away, free past 1500) as the original did.
Title and menus	Title, difficulty, pause, settings, map work. Continue broken (B-02). Add credits to the title, a "Quit" on Windows, controls remapping check.
Controller	Bindings exist for a gamepad; play the whole Prologue on one.
Saves	B-02; autosave; never lose progress on crash; one save slot is fine for the Prologue.
Onboarding	Intro storybook, tutorial cards, the lesson (B-01), first-time hints (echo, lantern, binder).
Text	Placeholder "Lorem ipsum" is intentional for unrestored people; check every other line is final, no typos, no debug text. The editor's "Playing: WASD..." bar is editor-only.
Balance	Play on Story and Normal: enemy damage, boss HP (Critic 110/77, Spoiler 190/133, Cold Shoulder 170, Scissor-Man 90), Mnemosynth income vs lantern costs, renown needed for the gate (220).
QA pass	A full play by a person on Windows from New Game to the end card, every chest, every site, both side rooms, both difficulties; then fix and repeat.

9. Suggested order

Step	Work	Why
1	B-01 lesson, B-02 save/Continue, B-03 item effects, V-05 HUD	Small, visible, affects every playthrough.
2	P-01 lantern upgrades + the rank/renown change (section 4)	Owner's request; gives Mnemosynth a purpose.
3	C-02 puzzle sites, C-03 riddles	Opens the 11 chests and most renown.
4	C-01 rift, Scissor-Man, publishing, Margin Gate, ending	Makes the Prologue finishable.
5	Cutscenes K-01..K-22, music and sound (section 6)	Production feel.
6	C-04 side rooms, C-05, B-04 equipment, B-05 crumpling	Completeness.
7	V-01..V-08 look, art, section 8 checklist, QA pass on Windows	Ship.

Definition of done

- From New Game: intro storybook, wake-up, lesson, three memories, three restorations (with cutscenes), rift, Scissor-Man, publishing, Margin Gate, end card, back to title with Continue.
- Every chest openable, every site/riddle/side room solvable, every item does what its card says.
- Resting at a lantern upgrades stats; the HUD shows level, ink, Mnemosynth and renown clearly.
- Music and sound throughout; cutscenes skippable after first viewing.
- Exported Windows build plays start to end with no errors, saves and continues; all tools/port tests pass, plus new ones for each item above.

How to build and test

```
cd /home/user/the_last_storytender            # branch all-merged
SKIP_CAPTURE=1 TILEWRIGHT=/home/user/calebwilsonit-tech/tilewrite tools/port/run_porter.sh
(cd /home/user/calebwilsonit-tech/tilewrite && npm run build)   # Tilewright main
node tools/port/static_check.mjs tilewright
TILEWRIGHT=... xvfb-run -a node tools/port/story_test.mjs tilewright <out>   # and the others
```

Rules: commit messages end with the session attribution lines; push to all-merged (git push -u origin all-merged); never open a pull request unless the owner asks; test before pushing and report honestly.